

Renata Gabriela Abbott Navarrete

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Education

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

University of California, San Diego
Advisor: Marc Muendler

2021–2027 (expected)

M.S. in Economic Analysis

University of Chile

2017–2018

B.A. in Economics

University of Chile

2012–2016

Research Interests

Fields: Macroeconomics and Trade

Selected Topics: Production networks, global value chains, firm dynamics, economic growth, international trade, spatial economics, and applied econometrics

References

Marc Muendler

Professor, Department of Economics
University of California, San Diego
muendler@ucsd.edu

Fabian Eckert

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
University of California, San Diego
feckert@ucsd.edu

Juan Herreño

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
University of California, San Diego
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Munseob Lee

Associate Professor, School of Global Policy and Strategy
University of California, San Diego
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Job Market Paper

Multiproduct Firm Growth and Production Networks

with Marco Rojas

How do firms' product and customer scopes interact inside production networks? Using the universe of firm-to-firm transactions in Chile, we show that these two dimensions of firm scope are strongly complementary. The largest growth episodes disproportionately combine new buyers with new products, and, conditional on sales and supplier fixed effects, a 10% increase in the number of buyers is associated with 0.2 additional product introductions. This expansion does not come at the expense of existing sales, suggesting that customer acquisition increases rather than reallocates the returns to product expansion. We develop a model of multiproduct firms embedded in a production network in which products require a firm-level adoption cost that can be amortized across buyer relationships. This generates two-way complementarity: acquiring buyers raises the return to expanding product scope, while a broader product portfolio raises the return to forming additional buyer links. Product–buyer match heterogeneity allows firms to sell different product sets to different customers and reproduces the partial alignment between firm-level and within-link product importance observed in the data. The calibrated model matches the empirical relationship between buyer acquisition and product introduction and implies substantial spillovers across the two margins: lower relationship-formation costs induce both more buyers and more products. Quantitatively, customer scope is particularly important for firm heterogeneity: the buyer margin alone accounts for about 90% of firm-size dispersion, compared with 63% for the product margin. Together, these results show that product scope and production-network formation cannot be understood in isolation: shocks affecting one dimension of firm scope propagate to the other.

Work in Progress

Trade Credit, Liquidity, and Network Contagion: Evidence from Transaction-Level Data
with Levent Altinoglu and Patricio Toro

Publications

Procyclicality of Bank Credit in Chile: The Roles of Foreign Banking and Financial Crises
with Tomás Gómez, Alejandro Jara and David Moreno
Research Note, The Chilean Economy, vol. 22, no. 2.

Research Experience

Research Assistant Core Member, Globalization and Prosperity Lab University of California, San Diego	2023–Present
Visiting PhD Candidate Financial and Monetary Policy Department Central Bank of Chile	2021–2023
Research Assistant Financial Policy Department Central Bank of Chile	2018–2021

Professional Experience

Financial Economic Analyst Financial Policy Department Central Bank of Chile	2018–2021
Professional Internship National Productivity Commission of Chile Ministry of Economy, Development, and Tourism of Chile	2016–2017

Teaching Experience

Associate Instructor – ECON 3 University of California, San Diego	2026
Teaching Assistant University of California, San Diego	2022–2026
Lecturer – Advanced Time Series (Master’s Program, EST724-01) Statistics Institute, Pontifical Catholic University of Valparaíso	2020–2021
Teaching Assistant University of Chile	2015–2019

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Advancement to Candidacy Fellowship University of California, San Diego	2024
Graduate Research Fellowship University of California, San Diego	2022–2023
Regents Fellowship University of California, San Diego	2021–2022

Seminars, Conferences, and Workshops

2026: LACEA-LAMES (*scheduled*)

2026: CESifo Junior Workshop on International Economics

2019: Central Bank of Chile Seminar

2019: Chilean Economic Society (SECHI)

Computer Skills

Stata, MATLAB, Python, Julia, SQL, R, L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent), Portuguese (intermediate)

Additional Information

Nationality: Chilean